

10 Tips & Tricks

This chapter aims to draw together the most common tips, tricks, and troubles. Over the next few pages, you'll find ideas for maximizing page space by manipulating overflowing content and learn to create incredibly simple CSS rollover images.

10.1 Rollover Images

A rollover image adds a simple bit of interaction for the user. Place the cursor over a rollover image, and another replaces it. For years, web designers preloaded on-state (i.e., on mouseover when the mouse is rolled over the image) images to assist the browser in its rollover presentation.

Preloading increases the weight of the initial download, but adds to usability by decreasing the wait time for an on-state image to appear. Basically, the browser would only start downloading the on-state image upon rollover.

All that is required in the HTML is the addition of a class to the `<a>` element.

```
<a href="target.html" class="rollover">Big Lee Hickman</a>
```

This unobtrusive additional markup allows you to take control of this particular link in any way you see fit using your style sheet.

Just one image is required for this technique. Both image states are combined as one image. This means that when the user rolls over the image, the on-state image is already available. The trick is to place the two versions side by side as one image, making very sure that each half is of an identical size. With this dual-purpose image prepared, we can now think about the CSS that will be used to slide the image backward and forward depending on the link state.

First, the rollover class is declared. All that is required is to assign the width and height of the visible area of the dual image and set the display to block (to ensure the dimensions are respected). The image itself is added using the background property, set to no-repeat.

```
/* Rollover class */
.rollover {
display:block;
width:210px;
height:157px;
background:url(/images/rollover.jpg) no-repeat;
```